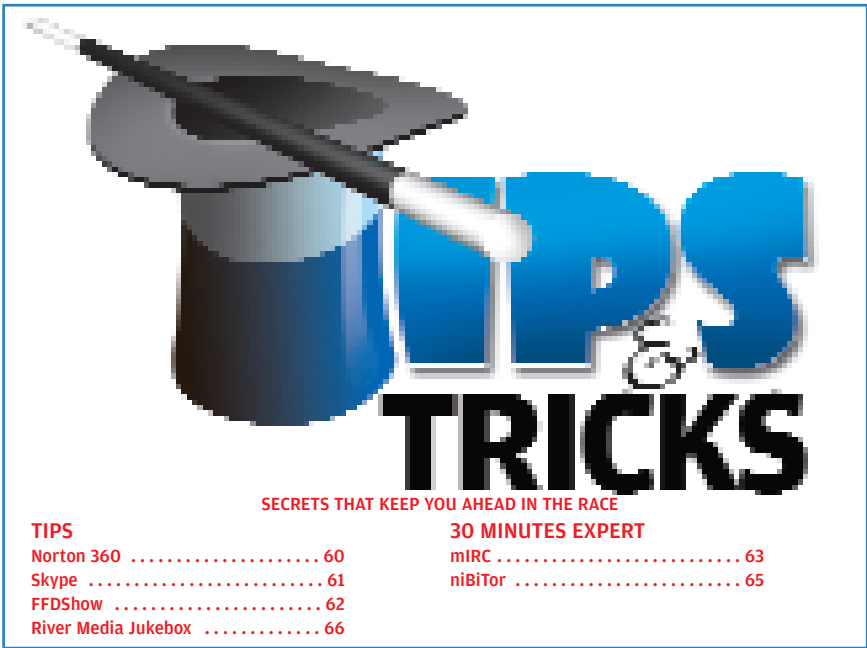




NORTON 360

Even though the competition has increased in the anti-virus and (in general) the security software market, Norton continues to steam ahead with its variety of suites and applications. We reviewed Norton 360 a few months ago and thought it pretty good. It was a little lighter than most Symantec products and, more importantly, it was easy to use for a newbie. Hidden away behind its colourful yellow interface lies a few advanced features, and these are what we'll be looking at here.

**Backing Up Data To Disc**  
Backups are important to keep all your important data safe from virus attacks. Norton 360 can back up data to a specified location, even to CD or DVD. Click on Tasks & Settings, then on Change Backup Settings. Step 2



Data backups can be made onto CD or DVDs as well

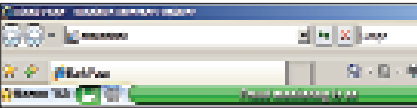
here has the Backup Location. Click on Change and select your CD-Writer or DVD-Writer drive. Click OK. Choose the folders to be backed up like you normally would. This time, when the backup process starts, the data will be put onto disc instead of a local hard drive. Once you've activated your copy of Norton 360, you'll get free online storage where you can back up your data to. In the same window where you selected the CD / DVD drive as your backup destination, you'll also find Secure Online Storage.

**The Controls?**  
Any newcomer to Norton 360 will be baffled by the interface—sure, it looks nice, but there are no clear buttons for scanning or for any of the other tasks. Go to Tasks & Settings. This window has all the functions. To scan, click the Run Scans link and choose from the type of scan you want to run. You can run a custom scan with only a few checks done by clicking Let me Choose.

**Full Backup**  
There is a big difference between the Quick and Full Backup in Norton 360. Quick Backup is used to back up all the important documents from your My Documents. The Full Backup will scan your entire hard drive for important files to back up. The Complete Backup is therefore the preferable one. To choose Complete Backup, click on Tasks & Settings. Click Change Backup Settings. At the top right, click on Full Backup and click Save Settings. The Full Backup might still miss out on certain important data that it can't

detect. In such cases, you can manually add folders and files by clicking on the Add a file or Add a folder buttons in the Backup Settings window.

**The Phishing Bar In Internet Explorer**  
The Phishing Bar in Internet Explorer is there to warn you of sites that could possibly be fakes. Norton 360 refers to its own database and provides warnings through the bar. This bar, if you do not want it, can be disabled by clicking on View > Toolbars > Show Norton Toolbar. If you want to disable the Phishing detection feature completely (if you use a browser not supported by Norton 360), you can do so by clicking on Tasks & Settings and then on Change Advanced Settings. On the right, uncheck the Transaction Security box. You can also disable pop-ups and updates from here if you wish to.



Add the Norton anti-phishing toolbar to IE

**PC Tune-up Schedule**  
Setting a schedule for the PC Tune-up is a good idea, we tend to hate running the whole line-up of scans when we're working. It's best to set a schedule time or an automatic weekly or monthly tune-up schedule. Go to



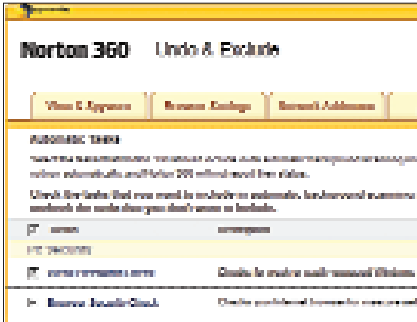
Scheduling PC tune-up sessions; it's a good idea to have the tune-up running when the PC is idle

Tasks and Settings, and then click on Change Advanced Settings from the menu on the right. Select Task Scheduling Settings. By default, the schedule for PC Tune-up is set to Automatic, and Norton 360 runs the schedule whenever it finds it suitable. Click on the drop-down and click on Weekly or Monthly scans. Choose the days or dates and the time you want the tune-up to start. Similarly, a schedule can be set for the backup as well.

**Undo And Exclude**  
The Undo and Exclude feature is implemented so that, should Norton 360 make any drastic changes to your data,

they can be undone. Go to Tasks and Settings > Change Advanced Settings > Undo & Exclude. There are tabs for Virus & Spyware, Browser Settings, and Network Addresses. Any changes to these components can be restored by clicking on the item and clicking Restore or Restore item to System.

**Enabling And Disabling Automatic Tasks**  
During a complete PC Tune-up, Norton 360 runs a whole lot of tests, which you might not want it to do. To disable some of these, click on Tasks and Settings > Change Advanced Settings > Undo & Exclude. For example, if you



Tasks that run automatically can be disabled

don't want to do a disk backup, you can uncheck the checkbox for the Backup task. Click Close when done.

**Creating Firewall Rules**  
Click on Tasks and Settings and then on Change Advanced Settings > Firewall Protection Settings. Here you'll see two tabs—Firewall General Rules and Firewall Program Rules. Firewall General Rules contains simple rules sets for the entire system, not for any particular program. The Firewall Program Rules screen lets you add your own rules for a program. All the programs using the Internet and the network will be displayed. Click on the drop-down next to the program and choose from the type of access you want to assign. If you choose Custom, a set of rules will be displayed from which you can choose. Click Add to add a new rule of your own. Follow the steps in the Wizard and the new rule will be created. You can create many rules for a single program in the same manner.

**Exceptions In Detecting Viruses And Spyware**  
Exceptions can be made to the different kinds of viruses and spyware scans that Norton 360 does on your system. One such setting exists; you can find it by going to Tasks and Settings > Change Advanced Settings > Virus & Spyware Protection

Settings. Under the Automatic Protection Settings tab, there is an option for ignoring low-risk threats. This is set to Ignore by default, and you can set it to Automatically Remove if you want. Click the Threat Categories tab if you want to disable any kind of threat if you use different software to check for those.

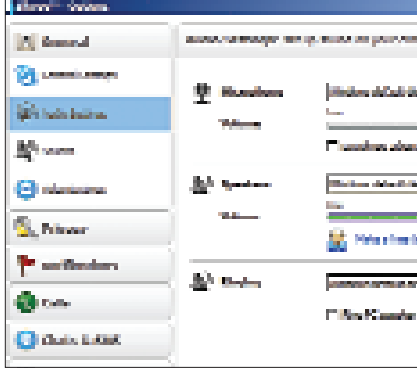
SKYPE

For those who aren't aware yet, Skype is a dedicated software for making phone calls over the Internet to another PC for free, or to land lines (which requires you to pay a fee). Here's a look at a few of Skype's important features, and some recommendations on add-ons.

**Checking Audio Quality**  
Ever wondered what you sound like to the person on the other end of a Skype call? Well, you need to make a call to echo123. First make all necessary audio setting changes. When you're ready to test it out, click on the address bar at the bottom of the Skype window and enter echo123. Press [Enter] and the call will be made. You will be asked to wait for a beep, after which you can speak. Your recorded message will then be played back. You can use this to tweak your audio recording settings.

**Skype Live**  
A nifty new addition to Skype, Skype Live allows users to create public voice chat rooms. You can connect and talk to people on all kinds of topics. Such meetings can also be planned well in advance, and a listing of current conversations can be found on the Skype site or from the Live tab right in Skype.

**Disable Sound Recording Normalisation**  
Skype has a feature that changes the volume at which your voice is recorded—depending on any sudden changes in



Disable Skype's control over the volume control if the feature doesn't work effectively

volume. This, in some cases, does not work effectively, and could result in low recording volume. The feature can be disabled by going to Tools > Options > General > Audio Settings. Uncheck the Let Skype Adjust my Audio Settings box. Here, as you'll see, you can also force a volume for the microphone and speakers.

**Using Your PC's Internal Speaker As A Ringer**  
If you're using a headset for Skype, there's no way of knowing if you have a Skype call when you aren't wearing the headphones. An easy trick to use the internal PC speaker as a ringer. Go to Tools > Options > General > Audio Settings. Under the Ringing section, check the Ring PC Speaker box and click Save.

**Skype On The Move**  
Like many other software, Skype can be used as a portable application. This means you can carry your (personal) Skype installation around with you on your portable music player or USB drive. First install Skype like you normally would on your hard drive. Then, from the installed location, which is usually C:\Program Files\Skype\Phone, copy Skype.exe to a folder on your USB drive. Create a folder called Data inside that folder. Start Notepad, type in Skype.exe /datapath="Data" /removable. Save the file as Skype.bat in the same folder as Skype.exe on the USB drive. Run it and enter the information like you normally would in a fresh installation. Check the box for Sign me in when Skype starts if you want to be able to double-click on the BAT file and log in automatically from any computer.

**Contact Management**  
Contacts in Skype are just like in any other program. You might have a bunch of friends from school and some others who don't have everyone in their list. Skype allows you to forward these contacts to others. Select Tools > Send Contacts. Hold down [Ctrl] and click on the contacts you want to send. In the Send contacts to field, enter the contact to whom you want to send the list. Click Send. The other interesting feature people usually miss out on is Groups. Go to View > Contact Groups > Enable Contact Groups. In the small Groups bar that appears above your contact list, click on the + icon to create